One Pager – Assignment #2
Geography 5300
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Research Problem: Nature in urban settings can be sporadic and of poor quality. This can negatively affect the quality of the natural habitat and minimize nature's possible benefits to the urban environment.

Research Questions: How can urban planners both fulfill the needs of an expanding population and maintain the integrity of the natural areas in and around the urban environment? Can conservation corridors acting as conduits between natural areas in and around the urban environment be one of the solutions?

Methodology: A literature review will be used to investigate the need, design, and use of conservation corridors acting as conduits between natural areas in and around the urban environment. This should reveal areas of interest. After the topic is narrowed, more information from academic books, journals and other periodicals will be used to gather more information on the topic selected. Once all the known information is gathered, scenarios of various corridors will be analyzed by diagrams and/or GIS plus before/after studies will be examined quantifying the effectiveness of using corridors and linking natural areas.

Expected Result: It's expected to find varying designs of linkages based on either a targeted species to be protected, topography of the area, political environment or urban design or combinations of these. The effectiveness of these will be quantified and examined as well.

Literature: Four peer reviewed articles of interest have helped with the literature review

- "Wildlife Corridors: An Urban Political Ecology" by James P. Evans. This article looks into the political process and semantics involving the use of the word phrase "wildlife corridors" in local politics and its ramifications.
- "Conserving Connectivity: Some Lessons from Mountain Lions in Southern California" by Scott A. Morrison. This article looks into how connecting natural areas affects mountain lions in Southern California.
- "Communicating clearly about conservation corridors" by George R. Hess and Richard A Fischer. This article discusses the many uses of corridors including: conduit, habitat, filter, barrier, source, and sink. My concentration may be how a corridor is used as a conduit between natural areas.
- "Conservation Value of Clustered Housing Developments" by Buffy A, Lenth. This article, the effectiveness of clustered housing in maintaining the integrity of the surrounding natural area.

Potential Advisor: Ron Hagelman. He taught the Geography of Land Management (5339) class I took last year.